

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET G — FINAL MASTERY & GRAND CHALLENGE TEST (60 MINS)****CHAPTER 07: ELECTIONS**

TIME ALLOWED: 60 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-G-07

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET G - Final Mastery & Grand Challenge Test):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Olympiad / NTSE / Advanced Analytical Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Designed for **Final Curricular Mastery & In-Depth Analytical Rigour**: Target time is **60 Minutes**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

**GRAND CHALLENGE SPECIAL:** This final assessment tests your multi-disciplinary analytical reasoning across historical source criticism, geomorphological dynamics, constitutional jurisprudence, and microeconomic market equilibria!

Q1. Under Article 324 of the Indian Constitution, the Election Commission of India (ECI) is vested with the power of 'superintendence, direction, and control' of elections. To safeguard its constitutional independence, how can the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) be removed from office?

- ☐ A Through an executive order issued by the Prime Minister at will ☐ B Only through an impeachment process in Parliament on grounds of proved misbehaviour or incapacity, identical to the removal procedure of a Supreme Court Judge (requiring a special majority in both Houses) ☐ C By a simple majority vote in the Rajya Sabha alone ☐ D By a resolution passed by all state governors acting jointly

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Under Article 324(5), the CEC enjoys constitutional security of tenure and can be removed only in like manner and on the like grounds as a Judge of the Supreme Court (special majority under Article 124(4)).

Q2. What is the primary difference in political outcomes between the 'First-Past-The-Post' (FPTP / Plurality) electoral system used in Indian Lok Sabha elections and a 'Proportional Representation' (PR) system?

- ☐ A FPTP requires every winning candidate to secure at least 50% + 1 of all votes cast ☐ B FPTP awards the seat to the candidate with the highest votes in a single-member constituency (even if below 50%), often creating manufactured parliamentary majorities, whereas PR allocates seats in direct proportion to total party vote share ☐ C PR can be used only in countries with populations under 100,000 citizens ☐ D FPTP completely eliminates the participation of independent candidates

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Under FPTP (plurality), a candidate with the highest individual vote tally wins, which often produces seat shares significantly higher than popular vote shares, whereas PR mirrors nationwide popular voting percentages.

Q3. Under Section 126 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, what is the mandatory 'Silence Period' (Purdah period) enforced prior to voting?

- ☐ A A 48-hour period ending with the hour fixed for the conclusion of the poll, during which public campaigning, election rallies, and televised political advertising are strictly prohibited ☐ B A 7-day period during which all newspapers in the state are suspended ☐ C A 24-hour period where voters are not allowed to step outside their homes ☐ D A 12-hour period during which only the ruling party is allowed to broadcast manifestos

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: RPA Section 126 prohibits holding public meetings, processions, musical concerts, and displaying election matter via TV/media during the 48 hours ending with the conclusion of polling.

Q4. In the landmark Supreme Court ruling in Lily Thomas v. Union of India (2013), what crucial electoral reform was established regarding convicted legislators?

- ☐ A Convicted legislators were given 5 years of immunity to complete their term ☐ B Section 8(4) of the RPA 1951 was struck down as unconstitutional, mandating the immediate disqualification of any sitting MP or MLA sentenced to two or more years of imprisonment upon conviction ☐ C Convicted legislators were allowed to vote via proxy post cards ☐ D Disqualification was made applicable only to local panchayat ward members

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The Supreme Court invalidated Section 8(4) of the RPA 1951, which previously shielded convicted MPs and MLAs from disqualification if they filed an appeal within 3 months, ending special legislative immunity.

Q5. What was the significance of the Supreme Court's ruling in Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) v. Union of India (2002)?

- ☐ A It mandated that every candidate filing nomination papers must submit a sworn affidavit disclosing their criminal antecedents, assets, liabilities, and educational qualifications as a constitutional right of voters under Article 19(1)(a) ☐ B It made voting legally compulsory for all salaried bank employees ☐ C It banned private donations to political parties permanently ☐ D It authorized the Election Commission to print currency during election campaigns

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: In the ADR 2002 judgment, the Supreme Court declared that voters have a fundamental 'Right to Know' under Article 19(1)(a), making affidavit disclosure (Form 26) of criminal cases, assets, and education mandatory.

Q6. In the Delimitation of Parliamentary and Assembly Constituencies, what is the constitutional role of the Delimitation Commission established under Article 82 of the Indian Constitution?

- ☐ A To print physical paper currency for candidates' campaign expenses ☐ B To redraw territorial constituency boundaries and allocate reserved seats for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes based on the latest decennial census, with its orders carrying the force of law and immune from judicial challenge under Article 329 ☐ C To select cabinet ministers for the governing coalition ☐ D To audit private corporate balance sheets of infrastructure companies

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The Delimitation Commission is a high-powered statutory body headed by a retired Supreme Court judge that re-adjusts territorial boundaries; under Article 329, its final orders cannot be called into question in any court.

Q7. Why were the number of Lok Sabha seats frozen based on the 1971 Census through the 42nd Amendment (1976) and extended up to 2026 by the 84th Amendment (2001)?

- ☐ A Because the Indian Parliament ran out of physical chairs in the chamber ☐ B To incentivize family planning and ensure that southern states successfully controlling population growth were not penalized with reduced political representation relative to states with higher fertility rates ☐ C Because the Supreme Court banned the decennial census after 1971 ☐ D Because the British Crown retained control over constituency borders until 2026

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The constitutional freeze ensured that states implementing effective population control (such as Kerala and Tamil Nadu) did not lose parliamentary seats to states with high population growth rates.

Q8. Under the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) enforced by the Election Commission of India, what restriction is placed on the ruling party from the moment elections are announced?

- ☐ A Ministers cannot breathe without written permission from the district magistrate ☐ B Ministers cannot announce financial grants, lay foundation stones of public projects, make ad-hoc appointments, or utilize government machinery/aircraft for partisan campaign activities ☐ C Ruling party members are barred from casting their personal votes on polling day ☐ D The ruling party must immediately surrender all state bank reserves to the United Nations

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The MCC prevents ruling incumbents from misusing official apparatus (announcing new schemes, using state aircraft, advertising with public funds) to gain an unfair advantage over the opposition.

Q9. In the Indian electoral apparatus, who serves as the pivotal operational authority at the district level responsible for conducting free and fair parliamentary/assembly polls?

- ☐ A The District Magistrate / Collector, acting ex-officio as the District Election Officer (DEO) and Returning Officer (RO) under ECI deputation ☐ B The President of the local Rotary Club ☐ C The senior-most private industrialist of the district ☐ D The state police inspector general acting independently of the ECI

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The District Magistrate serves as District Election Officer (DEO) and Returning Officer (RO), deemed on constitutional deputation to the ECI under Article 324, overseeing all polling stations and security.

Q10. What is the function of the Voter Verifiable Paper Audit Trail (VVPAT) system introduced following the Supreme Court judgment in Subramanian Swamy v. ECI (2013)?

- ☐ A It sends an instant SMS confirmation to the voter's mobile phone ☐ B It generates a transparent paper slip visible to the voter for 7 seconds showing the chosen candidate's serial number, name, and symbol before dropping into a sealed compartment, creating an independent physical audit trail ☐ C It prints a take-home souvenir receipt for the voter to show their employer ☐ D It calculates income tax rebates based on candidate choice

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: VVPAT prints a paper slip displaying the candidate name and symbol through a transparent window for 7 seconds before securely dropping into a sealed ballot box, enabling physical recount audits.

Q11. In *People's Union for Civil Liberties (PUCL) v. Union of India* (2013), what landmark option did the Supreme Court direct the Election Commission to provide on EVMs and ballot papers?

- ☐ A 'None of the Above' (NOTA) button, enabling voters to exercise a secret negative vote and reject all contesting candidates ☐ B A second-choice preference button for foreign diplomats ☐ C A mandatory donation button for election commission employees ☐ D A button to eliminate the constituency from parliament entirely

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The Supreme Court directed the provision of the NOTA button, holding that the right to reject candidates without compromising secret voting is an integral aspect of free expression under Article 19(1)(a).

Q12. What is the legal status and enforceability of the Model Code of Conduct (MCC)?

- ☐ A It is a constitutional statute passed by Parliament with penal imprisonment clauses ☐ B It originated as a voluntary consensus among political parties in Kerala (1960), but the ECI exercises plenary regulatory enforcement backed by Article 324 and Supreme Court precedents (*Mohinder Singh Gill* case) ☐ C It has zero legal force and is completely ignored by all election observers ☐ D It applies only to municipal corporation elections in metropolitan cities

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The MCC is not a statutory parliamentary act, but the Supreme Court has repeatedly affirmed that ECI's plenary powers under Article 324 permit strict enforcement of MCC to maintain free and fair elections.

Q13. Duverger's Law in political science hypothesizes which structural relationship between electoral systems and party dynamics?

- ☐ A First-Past-The-Post (single-member plurality) electoral systems tend mathematically to produce a stable two-party system, whereas Proportional Representation encourages multi-party coalitions ☐ B Proportional representation always leads to single-party military dictatorships ☐ C Elections conducted on Mondays always yield lower turnout than Sunday elections ☐ D Electronic voting machines always generate precisely three political parties

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Maurice Duverger observed that plurality single-ballot voting (FPTP) systematically marginalizes third parties (mechanical and psychological effects), favouring a two-party equilibrium.

Q14. What is 'Gerrymandering' in electoral geography?

- ☐ A The engineering of polling booth queues to speed up voting ☐ B The deliberate redrawing of electoral district boundaries to dilute opposition votes and confer unfair electoral advantages to the governing political party ☐ C The practice of counting votes under international satellite surveillance ☐ D The translation of election rules into local regional dialects

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Gerrymandering is the partisan manipulation of constituency boundaries (via 'cracking' and 'packing') to establish an artificial electoral advantage for a particular political party.

Q15. Under the Indian Constitution, how are constituencies reserved for Scheduled Castes (SC) and Scheduled Tribes (ST) structured in Lok Sabha elections?

- ☐ A Only SC and ST voters are permitted to cast ballots in these constituencies ☐ B All registered adult voters in the constituency participate in voting, but only candidates belonging to the recognized SC or ST categories are legally eligible to contest ☐ C SC and ST candidates contest against each other in separate private assemblies ☐ D Reserved seats rotate every single week by lottery

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: India operates joint electorates: in an SC or ST reserved constituency, every registered voter regardless of caste casts a vote, but only persons belonging to the designated SC/ST community can file nominations.

Q16. Under Section 77 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, what expenditure must be maintained by an election candidate?

- ☐ A Candidates must keep a separate and correct account of all election expenditure incurred between nomination and declaration of results, subject to statutory expenditure ceilings set by the ECI ☐ B Candidates must report only expenses paid in gold bullions ☐ C Expenditure accounts are purely voluntary and can be discarded after polling ☐ D Candidates are required to spend at least 50% of their net worth on advertising

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Candidates must maintain daily expenditure registers and submit sworn accounts within 30 days of results. Exceeding statutory limits or false filings can lead to disqualification under RPA Section 10A.

Q17. What was the historical significance of the 61st Constitutional Amendment Act, 1988 in the expansion of Indian democratic franchise?

- ☐ A It made land ownership a mandatory qualification for voting ☐ B It amended Article 326 to lower the voting age for Lok Sabha and Legislative Assembly elections from 21 years to 18 years ☐ C It introduced postal ballots for all corporate executives ☐ D It restricted voting rights exclusively to university graduates

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The 61st Amendment (effective March 1989) lowered the constitutional voting age from 21 to 18 years, enfranchising millions of youth and deepening universal adult suffrage under Article 326.

Q18. In the T.N. Seshan era (Chief Election Commissioner from 1990 to 1996), what transformative institutional reforms were enforced by the Election Commission of India?

- ☐ A The introduction of Electoral Photo Identity Cards (EPIC), rigorous enforcement of the Model Code of Conduct, eradication of booth capturing, and strict monitoring of campaign expenditure limits ☐ B The privatization of the election process to foreign commercial banks ☐ C The cancellation of all parliamentary elections for an entire decade ☐ D The replacement of paper ballots with verbal oaths in front of village elders

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: T.N. Seshan fiercely asserted the autonomy of Article 324, introducing Voter ID cards (EPIC), halting booth capturing, penalizing liquor distribution, and enforcing strict adherence to campaign rules.

Q19. What is the primary role of an 'Election Observer' appointed by the Election Commission of India under Section 20B of the RPA 1951?

- ☐ A To campaign on behalf of the central ruling coalition in rural villages ☐ B To act as the direct eyes and ears of the Commission, with statutory authority to oversee polling, investigate complaints, and even direct the Returning Officer to stop counting in case of irregularities ☐ C To print ballot papers at private commercial printing presses ☐ D To approve the political party manifestos before publication

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: ECI Observers (General, Expenditure, and Police Observers) are senior civil servants from outside the state who monitor compliance and possess powers under Section 20B to halt counting if fairness is compromised.

Q20. What happens to the security deposit lodged by an election candidate if they fail to secure a minimum threshold of popular votes in a parliamentary constituency?

- ☐ A The deposit is doubled and refunded with bank interest ☐ B The deposit is forfeited to the government treasury if the candidate fails to secure more than one-sixth (16.67%) of the total valid votes polled in the constituency ☐ C The candidate is barred from travelling abroad for ten years ☐ D The deposit is transferred to the winning candidate's campaign fund

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: To deter non-serious candidates, the RPA dictates that any candidate failing to secure at least one-sixth (1/6th or 16.67%) of the total valid votes polled forfeits their statutory security deposit.

Q21. How does the 'Systematic Voters' Education and Electoral Participation' (SVEEP) program designed by the ECI strengthen Indian democracy?

- ☐ A By funding the election campaigns of independent candidates ☐ B By conducting targeted voter literacy, electoral registration drives, EVM-VVPAT awareness, and ethical voting campaigns, particularly focusing on youth, women, and persons with disabilities ☐ C By disqualifying voters who miss local council elections ☐ D By providing free airline tickets to voters on election day

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: SVEEP is the flagship voter education initiative of the ECI designed to eliminate voter apathy, enhance registration in electoral rolls, and promote informed, ethical, and inclusive voting.

Q22. Under Article 329(b) of the Constitution of India, how can the election of any returned candidate to Parliament or a State Legislature be legally challenged?

- ☐ A By filing a complaint with the local municipal police station ☐ B Exclusively through an 'Election Petition' presented to the High Court of the respective state after the conclusion of the election ☐ C By submitting a memorandum to the President of India within 24 hours of counting ☐ D By holding a referendum among voters of the constituency

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Article 329(b) stipulates that no election to Parliament or State Legislature can be challenged except through an Election Petition filed before the High Court under the RPA 1951.

Q23. Why is the use of 'Indelible Ink' (silver nitrate solution) applied to the left forefinger of voters on polling day an essential safeguard against electoral fraud?

- ☐ A It conducts electricity to activate the digital EVM ballot unit ☐ B It reacts with skin proteins to form an insoluble silver chloride compound that cannot be washed away with soap or chemicals for weeks, preventing fraudulent double or multiple voting ☐ C It verifies the voter's biometric Aadhaar credentials via infrared sensors ☐ D It acts as a medical antiseptic against airborne bacterial infections

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Developed by National Physical Laboratory (NPL) and manufactured by Mysore Paints, indelible ink contains silver nitrate that stains skin/keratin permanently, physically blocking impersonation.

Q24. What is the critical function of 'Polling Agents' seated inside the polling booth on election day?

- ☐ A They are armed guards who manage crowd control outside the booth ☐ B They are authorized representatives of contesting candidates who verify voter identities against the electoral roll, witness the mock poll, and verify the sealing of EVM machines ☐ C They are government civil servants who assist elderly voters in pressing buttons ☐ D They are international media journalists who broadcast live video feeds

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: Polling agents appointed by candidates inspect the mock poll (confirming EVMs read zero before start), cross-check voter credentials against roll entries, and ensure tamper-proof seal application.

Q25. What is a 'Mock Poll' conducted by the Presiding Officer before the commencement of official voting on election day?

- ☐ A A comedy skit performed by election workers to entertain waiting voters ☐ B A mandatory demonstration in the presence of candidate polling agents where at least 50 test votes are cast across all buttons on the EVM/VVPAT, verified, cleared from memory, and documented in a signed certificate ☐ C A practice election held by school children two days before voting ☐ D An online computer simulation conducted at the district headquarters

Scholarly Concept & Analysis: The Presiding Officer must cast at least 50 test votes across all candidates in the presence of party polling agents, verify VVPAT paper slips against electronic tally, clear memory to zero, and seal the unit.

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET G)

01	A B C D	02	A B C D	03	A B C D	04	A B C D	05	A B C D
06	A B C D	07	A B C D	08	A B C D	09	A B C D	10	A B C D
11	A B C D	12	A B C D	13	A B C D	14	A B C D	15	A B C D
16	A B C D	17	A B C D	18	A B C D	19	A B C D	20	A B C D
21	A B C D	22	A B C D	23	A B C D	24	A B C D	25	A B C D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & IN-DEPTH SCHOLARLY EXPLANATIONS (SET G)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Scholarly Analysis
1	B	Under Article 324(5), the CEC enjoys constitutional security of tenure and can be removed only in like manner and on the like grounds as a Judge of the Supreme Court (special majority under Article 124(4)).
2	B	Under FPTP (plurality), a candidate with the highest individual vote tally wins, which often produces seat shares significantly higher than popular vote shares, whereas PR mirrors nationwide popular voting percentages.
3	A	RPA Section 126 prohibits holding public meetings, processions, musical concerts, and displaying election matter via TV/media during the 48 hours ending with the conclusion of polling.
4	B	The Supreme Court invalidated Section 8(4) of the RPA 1951, which previously shielded convicted MPs and MLAs from disqualification if they filed an appeal within 3 months, ending special legislative immunity.
5	A	In the ADR 2002 judgment, the Supreme Court declared that voters have a fundamental 'Right to Know' under Article 19(1)(a), making affidavit disclosure (Form 26) of criminal cases, assets, and education mandatory.
6	B	The Delimitation Commission is a high-powered statutory body headed by a retired Supreme Court judge that re-adjusts territorial boundaries; under Article 329, its final orders cannot be called into question in any court.
7	B	The constitutional freeze ensured that states implementing effective population control (such as Kerala and Tamil Nadu) did not lose parliamentary seats to states with high population growth rates.
8	B	The MCC prevents ruling incumbents from misusing official apparatus (announcing new schemes, using state aircraft, advertising with public funds) to gain an unfair advantage over the opposition.
9	A	The District Magistrate serves as District Election Officer (DEO) and Returning Officer (RO), deemed on constitutional deputation to the ECI under Article 324, overseeing all polling stations and security.
10	B	VVPAT prints a paper slip displaying the candidate name and symbol through a transparent window for 7 seconds before securely dropping into a sealed ballot box, enabling physical recount audits.
11	A	The Supreme Court directed the provision of the NOTA button, holding that the right to reject candidates without compromising secret voting is an integral aspect of free expression under Article 19(1)(a).
12	B	The MCC is not a statutory parliamentary act, but the Supreme Court has repeatedly affirmed that ECI's plenary powers under Article 324 permit strict enforcement of MCC to maintain free and fair elections.
13	A	Maurice Duverger observed that plurality single-ballot voting (FPTP) systematically marginalizes third parties (mechanical and psychological effects), favouring a two-party equilibrium.
14	B	Gerrymandering is the partisan manipulation of constituency boundaries (via 'cracking' and 'packing') to establish an artificial electoral advantage for a particular political party.
15	B	India operates joint electorates: in an SC or ST reserved constituency, every registered voter regardless of caste casts a vote, but only persons belonging to the designated SC/ST community can file nominations.
16	A	Candidates must maintain daily expenditure registers and submit sworn accounts within 30 days of results. Exceeding statutory limits or false filings can lead to disqualification under RPA Section 10A.
17	B	The 61st Amendment (effective March 1989) lowered the constitutional voting age from 21 to 18 years, enfranchising millions of youth and deepening universal adult suffrage under Article 326.
18	A	T.N. Seshan fiercely asserted the autonomy of Article 324, introducing Voter ID cards (EPIC), halting booth capturing, penalizing liquor distribution, and enforcing strict adherence to campaign rules.
19	B	ECI Observers (General, Expenditure, and Police Observers) are senior civil servants from outside the state who monitor compliance and possess powers under Section 20B to halt counting if fairness is compromised.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Concept & Scholarly Analysis
20	B	To deter non-serious candidates, the RPA dictates that any candidate failing to secure at least one-sixth (1/6th or 16.67%) of the total valid votes polled forfeits their statutory security deposit.
21	B	SVEEP is the flagship voter education initiative of the ECI designed to eliminate voter apathy, enhance registration in electoral rolls, and promote informed, ethical, and inclusive voting.
22	B	Article 329(b) stipulates that no election to Parliament or State Legislature can be challenged except through an Election Petition filed before the High Court under the RPA 1951.
23	B	Developed by National Physical Laboratory (NPL) and manufactured by Mysore Paints, indelible ink contains silver nitrate that stains skin/keratin permanently, physically blocking impersonation.
24	B	Polling agents appointed by candidates inspect the mock poll (confirming EVMs read zero before start), cross-check voter credentials against roll entries, and ensure tamper-proof seal application.
25	B	The Presiding Officer must cast at least 50 test votes across all candidates in the presence of party polling agents, verify VVPAT paper slips against electronic tally, clear memory to zero, and seal the unit.